Pemetrexed + Cisplatin

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00317 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before the visit

Confirm blood-test arrangements, transport, prescriptions, B12 booking and the 24-hour contact number. Tell the team if you are ill before travelling.

STEP 2

Time in the unit

Pemetrexed is given into a vein over about 10 minutes, followed by cisplatin over about 60 minutes, starting 30 minutes after pemetrexed. Fluids before and after cisplatin make the visit longer; the team individualises hydration and electrolyte replacement. The whole visit also includes blood-result review, prevention medicines, preparation and observation.

STEP 3

Access for treatment

Treatment may use a small cannula or an existing suitable central line. The team chooses access for your veins and treatment plan. There is no routine take-home infusion pump in this regimen; ask for line-care instructions if you have a line.

STEP 4

Home medicines

Keep your vitamin, steroid, anti-sickness and rescue plans together. Ask the pharmacist to resolve duplicate dexamethasone directions before taking them.

STEP 5

Support and review

Arrange help with travel and daily tasks if needed. Bring symptom notes, a medicines list and questions to review. Request more passport pages rather than treating the printed page count as a course limit.

Sources: NCCP 00317 v7 · official regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.